

History of Anesthesia MCQ – Chapter 8

Source: Short Textbook of Anesthesia – Ajay Yadav

Section 4: Introduction to Anesthesia (Chapter 8)

25 Questions • 20 Minutes

Instructions:

- Each question has 4 options (A, B, C, D).
- The correct answer is shown on the right side of each question.
- Detailed explanations with textbook page references are at the end.

Questions

Q1. Who used the term 'anesthesia' in 1st AD to describe the narcotic effects of the plant Mandragora?

- A. Dioscorides
- B. Oliver Wendell Holmes
- C. John Lundy
- D. Ralph Waters

Ans: A

Q2. The word 'anesthesia', which means no senses, was coined by:

- A. Dioscorides
- B. Oliver Wendell Holmes
- C. Humphry Davy
- D. Horace Wells

Ans: B

Q3. The term 'balanced anesthesia' was coined by:

- A. Priestley and Davy
- B. Morton and Snow
- C. John Lundy and Ralph Waters
- D. Carl Koller and August Bier

Ans: C

Q4. Which was the first anesthetic gas, and who synthesized it in 1774?

- A. Ether, synthesized by Valerius Cordus
- B. Nitrous oxide, synthesized by Priestley
- C. Chloroform, synthesized by John Snow
- D. Cyclopropane, synthesized by Humphry Davy

Ans: B

Q5. Who first used nitrous oxide on himself for a toothache and called it 'laughing gas'?

- A. Joseph Priestley
- B. Horace Wells
- C. Humphry Davy
- D. W.T.G. Morton

Ans: C

Q6. The first public clinical demonstration of nitrous oxide (1845) was given by Horace Wells for what procedure?

- A. Tooth extraction
- B. Removal of jaw tumor
- C. Childbirth
- D. Limb amputation

Ans: A

Q7. Horace Wells became addicted to which agent and later committed suicide by cutting his femoral artery? A. Nitrous oxide B. Ether C. Cocaine D. Chloroform	Ans: D
Q8. Ether was prepared by Valerius Cordus in 1540 and was known by what name? A. Laughing gas B. Sweet oil of vitriol C. Dephlogisticated air D. Spirit of salt	Ans: B
Q9. Who gave the first public demonstration of ether anesthesia on 16th October 1846? A. WTG Morton B. John Snow C. Horace Wells D. Carl Koller	Ans: A
Q10. Which date is celebrated as World Anesthesia Day? A. 14th February B. 1st AD C. 16th October D. 12th March	Ans: C
Q11. The first successful demonstration of ether anesthesia by Morton took place at which hospital (Fig. 8.1)? A. Johns Hopkins Hospital B. Massachusetts General Hospital C. St. Thomas Hospital D. Hindu Rao Hospital	Ans: B
Q12. Who popularized chloroform and used it on Queen Victoria for the birth of her 8th child? A. WTG Morton B. Humphry Davy C. John Snow D. Valerius Cordus	Ans: C
Q13. In how many patients did John Snow use chloroform successfully? A. 4,000 patients B. 1,000 patients C. 10,000 patients D. 100 patients	Ans: A

Q14. The first intravenous anesthetic used was thiopentone. Who used it and in which year? A. Carl Koller, 1884 B. John Lundy, 1934 C. Harold Griffith, 1942 D. August Bier, 1898	Ans: B
Q15. The first local anesthetic used was cocaine. Who used it and for what purpose in 1884? A. Carl Koller, for anesthetizing the cornea B. J Leonard Corning, for spinal anesthesia C. August Bier, for epidural anesthesia D. John Lundy, for intravenous anesthesia	Ans: A
Q16. Who first gave spinal anesthesia in dogs? A. August Bier B. Carl Koller C. J Leonard Corning D. Cathelin and Sicard	Ans: C
Q17. The first spinal anesthesia in human beings was given by August Bier in which year? A. 1846 B. 1884 C. 1898 D. 1901	Ans: C
Q18. The first epidural anesthesia (1901) was given by: A. August Bier B. Cathelin and Sicard C. J Leonard Corning D. Carl Koller	Ans: B
Q19. Who was the first to use 'curare' for muscle relaxation in 1942? A. Harold Griffith B. Bovet C. John Lundy D. Ivan Magill	Ans: A
Q20. Bovet received the Nobel Prize (1949) for using which muscle relaxant in practice? A. Curare B. Pancuronium C. Suxamethonium (Succinylcholine) D. Atracurium	Ans: C

Q21. Who received the Nobel Prize in 1949 in connection with muscle relaxants? A. Harold Griffith B. Bovet C. John Lundy D. Edmund Gaskin Boyle	Ans: B
Q22. The first Boyle's machine was invented in 1917 by: A. Ivan Magill B. Edmund Gaskin Boyle C. Robert Boyle D. John Lundy	Ans: B
Q23. The first endotracheal intubation was done by: A. Edmund Gaskin Boyle B. WTG Morton C. Ivan Magill D. Carl Koller	Ans: C
Q24. Apart from synthesizing nitrous oxide, Priestley is also credited with synthesizing which other gas, which he called 'Dephlogisticated air'? A. Carbon dioxide B. Oxygen C. Nitrogen D. Helium	Ans: B
Q25. Ether anesthesia in Morton's first demonstration was used for removal of what? A. Jaw tumor B. A tooth C. An appendix D. A limb	Ans: A

Answer Key & Explanations

Q1. Answer: A — Dioscorides

Page 83: History of anesthesia dates back to 1st AD when Dioscorides used the term anesthesia to describe the narcotic effects of the plant Mandragora.

Topic: Introduction

Q2. Answer: B — Oliver Wendell Holmes

Page 83: The word anesthesia, which means no senses, was coined by Oliver Wendell Holmes.

Topic: Introduction

Q3. Answer: C — John Lundy and Ralph Waters

Page 83: The term 'balanced anesthesia' was coined by John Lundy and Ralph Waters.

Topic: Introduction

Q4. Answer: B — Nitrous oxide, synthesized by Priestley

Page 83: The first anesthetic gas, i.e. nitrous oxide, was synthesized by Priestley in 1774 (Priestley also synthesized oxygen, which he called Dephlogisticated air).

Topic: Nitrous Oxide

Q5. Answer: C — Humphry Davy

Page 83: The first clinical use of nitrous oxide was done by Humphry Davy, who used it on himself for toothache and called nitrous oxide as 'laughing gas'.

Topic: Nitrous Oxide

Q6. Answer: A — Tooth extraction

Page 83: The first public clinical demonstration of nitrous oxide was given by Horace Wells for tooth extraction (1845), but unfortunately the patient cried in pain.

Topic: Nitrous Oxide

Q7. Answer: D — Chloroform

Page 83: Horace Wells became so frustrated that he became a chloroform addict and committed suicide by cutting his femoral artery.

Topic: Nitrous Oxide

Q8. Answer: B — Sweet oil of vitriol

Page 83: Ether was prepared by Valerius Cordus in 1540 when it was known as 'sweet oil of vitriol'.

Topic: Ether

Q9. Answer: A — WTG Morton

Page 83: The first public demonstration of ether was given by WTG Morton on 16th October 1846, and that is why 16th October is celebrated as World Anesthesia Day.

Topic: Ether

Q10. Answer: C — 16th October

Page 83: The first public demonstration of ether was given by WTG Morton on 16th October 1846, and that is why 16th October is celebrated as World Anesthesia Day.

Topic: Ether

Q11. Answer: B — Massachusetts General Hospital

Page 83, Fig. 8.1: The first successful demonstration of ether anesthesia was by Morton in Massachusetts General Hospital.

Topic: Ether

Q12. Answer: C — John Snow

Page 84: It was John Snow who popularized chloroform, using it successfully in 4,000 patients. He used chloroform on Queen Victoria for the birth of her 8th child.

Topic: Chloroform

Q13. Answer: A — 4,000 patients

Page 84: It was John Snow who popularized chloroform, using it successfully in 4,000 patients.

Topic: Chloroform

Q14. Answer: B — John Lundy, 1934

Page 84: The first intravenous anesthetic used was thiopentone by John Lundy in 1934.

Topic: Intravenous Anesthetics

Q15. Answer: A — Carl Koller, for anesthetizing the cornea

Page 84: The first local anesthetic used was cocaine by Carl Koller for anesthetizing the cornea (1884).

Topic: Local Anesthesia

Q16. Answer: C — J Leonard Corning

Page 84: The first spinal anesthesia in dogs was given by J Leonard Corning, while the first spinal anesthesia in human beings was given by August Bier in 1898.

Topic: Local Anesthesia

Q17. Answer: C — 1898

Page 84: The first spinal anesthesia in human beings was given by August Beir (Bier) in 1898.

Topic: Local Anesthesia

Q18. Answer: B — Cathelin and Sicard

Page 84: The first epidural anesthesia was given by Cathelin and Sicard (1901).

Topic: Local Anesthesia

Q19. Answer: A — Harold Griffith

Page 84: Harold Griffith was the first to use 'curare' for muscle relaxation (1942).

Topic: Muscle Relaxants

Q20. Answer: C — Suxamethonium (Succinylcholine)

Page 84: Bovet got the Nobel Prize (1949) for using Suxamethonium (Succinylcholine) in practice.

Topic: Muscle Relaxants

Q21. Answer: B — Bovet

Page 84: Bovet got the Nobel Prize (1949) for using Suxamethonium (Succinylcholine) in practice.

Topic: Muscle Relaxants

Q22. Answer: B — Edmund Gaskin Boyle

Page 84: The first Boyle's machine was invented by Edmund Gaskin Boyle in 1917.

Topic: Instruments

Q23. Answer: C — Ivan Magill

Page 84: The first endotracheal intubation was done by Ivan Magill.

Topic: Instruments

Q24. Answer: B — Oxygen

Page 83: Priestley also synthesized oxygen, which he called Dephlogisticated air.

Topic: Nitrous Oxide

Q25. Answer: A — Jaw tumor

Page 100: First public demonstration of ether was given by WTG Morton on 16th October 1846 for the removal of jaw tumor.

Topic: Ether